MID-CENTURY MODERN: A RETRO-INSPIRED TEMPLATE

A RETRO LOOK, BUILT FOR MODERN PRESENTATIONS

YOUR NAME

YOUR INSTITUTION

OCTOBER 20, 2026

midcentury modern

TABLE OF CONTENTS

- **Template Overview**
  - Design Principles
  - Color Themes
- **Blocks**
  - Standard Blocks
  - Blocks in Columns
  - Alert and Example Blocks
- **Typography**
  - Text Formatting
  - Lists
- **Customisation**
- **Bibliography management**

SECTION 1

Template Overview

SECTION 1.1

Design Principles

Design Goals

- Typographic dash bullets that follow the text size
- Clean sans-serif typography
- Distinctive colour palette with two built-in themes

Requires LuaLaTeX

Font loading relies on `fontspec`, which requires LuaLaTeX or XeLaTeX. LuaLaTeX is recommended as the TikZ-based graphics perform best with its extended memory model.

SECTION 1.2

Color Themes

TWO BUILT-IN THEMES — KRAFT

Select a theme with a single command in your preamble:

1. **Kraft** — terracotta, kraft paper tones, warm accents
   `\mcmTheme{Kraft}`
2. **DeepBlue** — dark navy, crisp white, cool accents
   `\mcmTheme{DeepBlue}`

TWO BUILT-IN THEMES — DEEPBLUE

Select a theme with a single command in your preamble:

1. **Kraft** — terracotta, kraft paper tones, warm accents
   `\mcmTheme{Kraft}`
2. **DeepBlue** — dark navy, crisp white, cool accents
   `\mcmTheme{DeepBlue}`

SECTION 2

Blocks

SECTION 2.1

Standard Blocks

Observation

Standard blocks use the primary theme colour for the pip and title. The background matches the slide.

With a List Inside

- Bullets inherit the theme colour
- Indentation and spacing are consistent

SECTION 2.2

Blocks in Columns

BLOCKS IN COLUMNS

Overview

A **standard block** spanning the full width can introduce the content below, before splitting into multiple columns.

Design

- **Typographic** dash bullets at every level
- Clean sans-serif typography

Colour

- Two built-in themes: **Kraft** and **DeepBlue**
- Switched with a single command

Customisation

- Adjustable lengths and **font overrides**
- Compatible with `biblatex`

SECTION 2.3

Alert and Example Blocks

Note

Standard blocks use the primary theme colour for the pip and title. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco.

Warning

Alert blocks use amber.

- Bullets match the alert colour
- Background is a warm tint

Illustration

Example blocks use sage.

- Bullets match the example colour

ALERT AND EXAMPLE BLOCKS — DEEPBLUE THEME

Pink for alerts, mint for examples

Note

Standard blocks use the primary theme colour for the pip and title. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Sed do eiusmod tempor incididunt ut labore et dolore magna aliqua. Ut enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exercitation ullamco.

Warning

Alert blocks use pink.

- Bullets match the alert colour
- Background is a warm tint

Illustration

Example blocks use mint.

- Bullets match the example colour

SECTION 3

Typography

SECTION 3.1

Text Formatting

TEXT FORMATTING

Two families: one for the running text, one for the titles

Regular text uses the body font (TeX Gyre Heros, a Helvetica, by default).

Bold text for emphasis. *Italic text* for titles and foreign terms. Alerted text for warnings.

Frame titles use the title font (TeX Gyre Adventor, an Avant Garde Gothic, by default), letterspaced and rendered in uppercase.

Override fonts in your preamble:

- `\setsansfont{Font Name}` — body
- `\renewfontfamily\mcmTitleFont{Font Name}` — titles

SECTION 3.2

Lists

ITEMIZE AND ENUMERATE

The mark follows the size and weight of its own text

- First item
- Second item
  - Nested item
    - Deeper item
- Third item

1. First item
2. Second item
   1. Nested item
3. Third item

SECTION 4

Customisation

ADJUSTABLE PARAMETERS

Lengths

- `\mcmFrameTitleLeft` — frame title left padding
- `\mcmFrameTitleHeight` — one-line title band
- `\mcmFrameSubtitleGrow` — height a subtitle adds
- `\mcmBlockTitleIndent` — block title indent
- `\mcmBlockSep` — gap around blocks
- `\mcmBandPad` — block title band padding

Lengths (cont.)

- `\mcmFrameTitleRise`
- `\mcmTitleWordSpacing`
- `\mcmFooterHeight`
- `\mcmLogoVOffset`

Toggles

- `\mcmTitleUppercasefalse`

CUSTOMISATION EXAMPLES

Wider frame title left padding (default: 0.35cm)

```
\setlength{\mcmFrameTitleLeft}{1.2cm}
```

Pushes the frame title text further from the left edge.

Larger title page footer (default: 5em)

```
\setlength{\mcmFooterHeight}{7em}
```

Gives more room to the scan-line / logo area at the bottom.

Raise the logo (default: 0cm)

```
\setlength{\mcmLogoVOffset}{0.4cm}
```

Shifts the logo upward within the footer strip.

CUSTOMISATION EXAMPLES (CONT.)

Extra word spacing on the title (default: 0.5em)

```
\setlength{\mcmTitleWordSpacing}{1.2em}
```

Spreads words on the title page for a more open feel.

Disable uppercase frame titles

```
\mcmTitleUppercasefalse
```

Titles are rendered as typed, without `\MakeUppercase`.

Override body and title fonts

```
\setsansfont{Source Sans 3}
\renewfontfamily\mcmTitleFont{Futura}
```

Place these after `\usepackage{beamerthememidcenturymodern}`.

SECTION 5

Bibliography management

THE HISTORY OF MID-CENTURY MODERN

Mid-century modern (MCM) is a design movement that flourished roughly from 1945 to 1970, rooted in the Bauhaus principles of clean lines, geometric forms, and functionality over ornament (Wikipedia contributors 2026). The term itself was coined by Cara Greenberg in her 1984 book on 1950s furniture (Greenberg 1984). In graphic design, these ideals were systematised through grid-based composition (Müller-Brockmann 1981) and refined typographic practice (Bringhurst 2004).

REFERENCES

- Bringhurst, Robert (2004). *The Elements of Typographic Style*. 3rd. Vancouver: Hartley & Marks.
- Greenberg, Cara (1984). *Mid-Century Modern: Furniture of the 1950s*. New York: Harmony Books.
- Müller-Brockmann, Josef (1981). *Grid Systems in Graphic Design*. Sulgen, Switzerland: Niggli.
- Wikipedia contributors (2026). *Mid-century modern*. Accessed April 2026. URL: `https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Mid-century_modern`.

Closing slide
Any question?

Your backup slides here

Design Movement Timeline

